ISSUE 2

GALLIONS grapevine

October 2000

GALLIONS HOUSING ASSOCIATION

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The Anti-Graffiti team, left to right: Stuart Simpson, Cameron Sims, Clive Colvill, Laura Barry, Jane Barr, Vicky Holland, Jason Ward, Randolph Tuitt.

Beating graffiti

In the last issue of "Gallions Grapevine" Chief Executive, Tony Cotter, wrote about how we have started a major campaign to deal with graffiti more quickly and more effectively.

The work has already begun and we believe that it is working. However, we need your continued support and help if we are to clean up and eradicate this anti-social activity.

A number of you have already commented on the fact that you have noticed the difference we are making, which is very pleasing. One resident who contacted us said:

"What an excellent idea regarding the anti-graffiti posters and asking people to ring up and report areas where this is a problem. I have noticed already how much better the area around the Moorings is looking since you have started cleaning the graffiti."

She goes on to say: *"We do appreciate what everybody is trying to do in tidying up Thamesmead."*

If you spot some graffiti in your area, give our Graffiti Hotline a call on 0800 085 0809 **and we will send someone to clear it up.**



Welcome

Welcome to the second edition of "Gallions Grapevine", your newsletter from Gallions Housing Association.

If you have any suggestions for future features, would like to contribute an article, or have any comments about "Gallions Grapevine", then please write to me, Caroline Wilson, at Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London SE2 9XH

Caroline Wilson
Editor

Look inside for your invitation

This year we are holding our first ever *Working In Partnership* **Tenant Conference.**

Working In Partnership **will be a great opportunity for tenants, Board members and employees to get together and share ideas.**

We have our ideas of how to improve the service you receive and the area in which you live – but we want to hear what you have to say.

See back page for your list of contacts

Invitation

Working In Partnership Tenant Conference

Gallions Housing Association is pleased to invite you to its first Annual Tenant Conference

Our first conference will provide an opportunity for all residents to participate in wide ranging discussions as to the shape of Thamesmead as we move into the twenty first century.

Creating improved opportunities for the community is a top priority.

This is your chance to begin the discussion as to how you feel things should change.

YES, we are as concerned as you about the housing stock we have inherited. What can we do to improve it?

YES, we are as concerned as you about anti-social behaviour and the mindless disregard by a minority who wish to abuse their neighbourhoods.

You can help, don't stand on the sidelines. Participate in shaping the future of Thamesmead to make it a better place for all.

Working in Partnership will take place at

Thamesmere Leisure Centre
Saturday 9 December
Registration 9.45am

Please take the time to complete the reply slip below so that an indication of numbers can be given and any special requirements catered for:

Please return to: Caroline Wilson, Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London, SE2 9XH Telephone: 020 8320 3409.

✂

Working In Partnership

Gallions Housing Association Tenant Conference
Saturday 9 December at 10.00am

Name: _____

Address: _____

Dietary Requirements: _____

Creche Facility (pre-booked) Number and ages of children _____

Any other special needs _____

Divers clear lake



Tom Broad, John Fahy and Peter Copleston. Volunteer boat services provided by YMCA. Divers: Richard and Keith Maunders

Any resident seeing frogmen emerging from Southmere Lake recently was not imagining things. As part of our major clean up campaign, frogmen dived in the lake to find cars that have been dumped there over the years. In all 7 cars were found and removed from the lake.

Environment Agency confirm Thamesmead lakes comply with the EU purity standards

The Chief Executive of the Environment Agency this week confirmed that Thamesmead Lakes are well oxygenated and measure up to EU directive standards.

The Agency is responsible for water quality and fishery matters in the lakes and responds to pollution incidents reported by members of the public and emergency services.

Mr Gallagher, Chief Executive of the Environment Agency recently wrote to a tenant explaining that Gallions Housing Association employ environmental specialist to monitor the water quality of the lakes and as a result of a recent analysis, the lakes in Thamesmead are up to standard. He also confirmed that Gallions Housing Association have effective procedures in place for dealing with litter in and around Thamesmead. 7,000 kilograms of debris have been recovered from the lakes this year alone.

Gallions operate a litter collection service and you only have to call us on 0800 0850 809 to report a problem.

Be safe – be responsible

We all need to be careful about what we do to protect our neighbours and ourselves so that we can live in a safe and pleasant environment.

- **Protecting your children**

Make sure that your children do not play in dangerous areas or near technical equipment – they could come to harm and you may be liable for prosecution if any damage is done.

- **Protecting your home**

Make sure that when you go out, your doors and windows are securely locked.
Don't leave expensive items in sight
Don't leave a spare key under the mat or flowerpot
If you are going away for a while, ask a friend or neighbour to keep an eye on your home.

- **Protecting your empty vehicle**

Make sure all windows are closed and the car is locked
Don't leave items of value in view
Park near a streetlight if possible
Consider fitting an alarm

- **Protecting your pets**

Keep your dog under control at all times.
In some cases you may need to consider putting a muzzle on it.
Remember that you can be fined if your pet fouls in a public area

FEEDBACK

FEEDBACK is to be a regular feature of Gallions Grapevine. It is a space in the newsletter for your comments, suggestions ideas or views.

What do you think of Gallions Grapevine? Have you any comments on our service – good or bad? What is your view of living in Thamesmead? How could we improve the service we provide? What things really irritate you that we could do something about?

Let us know by writing to FEEDBACK, Gallions Grapevine, C/O Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London SE2 9XH.

Board profile

Anthony Cox
Tony was appointed to the Board on the 25th October 1999 as a Tenant Representative. He has previously served on the Board of Thamesmead Town Ltd. Tony is a single parent and lives in the Broadwaters area of Thamesmead. Tony is one of the Board of Governors ar Heronsgate School.



Anthony Cox

Mike French
Mike was appointed to the Board by Bexley Council on the 21st July 1999 as a Local Authority Nominee. Mike is also a member of the Policies and Procedures Committee. Mike is married to Liz and has three teenage children. He is currently employed as a Manager of a housing project for vulnerable people.



Mike French

BOARD MEETINGS

Gallions Housing Association's Board of Management meets on a regular basis. The meetings are open to all residents. In order to accommodate any residents who wish to attend, you would need to contact Caroline Wilson at our offices, (address below) prior to any meeting to make arrangements. The dates of the next meetings are:

Monday 30 October 2000
Monday 11 December 2000
Monday 22 January 2001

Board meetings are generally held at Gallions Housing Association offices, Harrow Manor Way, London SE2 9XH. However, we plan to hold the December meeting at St Paul's Church, Bentham Road. This meeting will be open to all tenants so that you can express your views.



Top TA award

You may have seen in the local papers that Keith Wrate, one of our Board members, has been awarded a top Territorial Army award. Keith was awarded the Lord Lieutenant's Certificate of Meritorious Service at a recent ceremony. His role in the TA includes training new recruits so that they learn the basic military skills that they need.

Our photograph, courtesy of the News Shopper, shows Keith receiving his award.

Gallions goes online



Our new website is now up and running. The site includes information on our services and a range of background detail. If you would like to check out the site for yourself, you can find it as www.gallionsha.co.uk.

www.gallionsha.co.uk



Just for fun

wordsearch

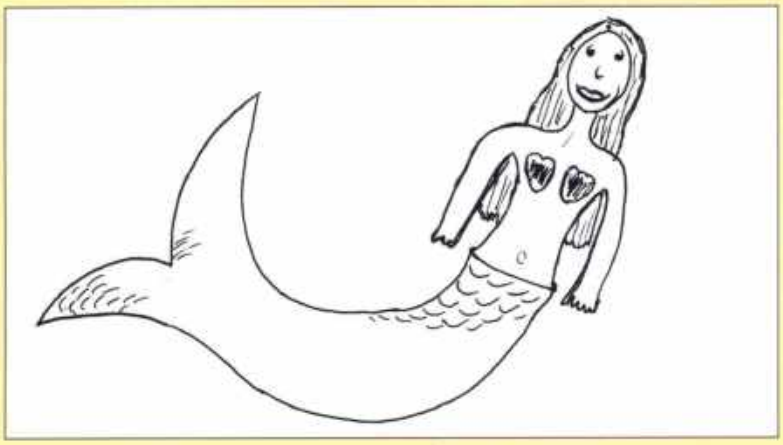
Can you find the names of ten Olympic events in the grid? The names can be found horizontally, vertically or diagonally.

Z	R	D	S	G	Q	C	B	E	Y	L	R
N	S	D	I	F	E	N	C	I	N	G	P
O	D	Y	U	S	W	I	M	M	I	N	G
H	H	T	M	V	C	N	J	L	O	I	S
T	N	X	V	K	K	U	M	F	G	W	F
A	T	I	B	S	D	S	S	R	X	O	A
R	J	M	L	O	G	M	T	K	O	R	H
A	G	I	V	E	X	Q	Q	T	A	B	K
M	O	V	U	G	V	I	B	D	N	V	B
J	S	C	I	T	S	A	N	M	Y	G	H
K	Q	X	J	H	L	Z	J	G	Y	Q	Q
X	T	A	Z	L	B	D	C	Z	I	A	I

In this month

1918	House of Common votes to allow women MPs
1934	The Government announces plans to bring London Transport into public ownership under one authority
1940	The 14 year old Princess Elizabeth makes her debut on radio
1949	A gallon of petrol goes up twopence halfpenny to 2/3d!
1959	Errol Flynn dies
1966	Postcodes are introduced
1974	Britain's first McDonald's hamburger restaurant opens in Woolwich
1987	England is hit by 110 mile an hour winds

Colour me in!



Picture by Hannah Duggie, 15



Wordsearch answers: gymnastics, fencing, javelin, judo, football, marathon, swimming, rowing, boxing, discus

020 8310 1500

ring this number for all Gallions departments

See back page for your full list of contacts

Customer First

In the first issue of "Gallions Grapevine" we announced Customer First, a long term initiative that gives, as the name suggests, priority to your needs.

We believe that Customer First will give the Association a more open, and responsive approach by putting your needs and views at the centre of everything we do.

It is about acting upon your views and improving all aspects of our services by taking positive action. We intend to build upon our strengths and to implement programs of improvement. Customer First will give you the opportunity to be involved and to shape our services.

Our graffiti initiative is a good example of how this can work if we all take responsibility for things. It is part of our "Clean Up Campaign" which also includes picking up litter and grass cutting. In the first week our Graffiti Hotline took 120 calls from residents – and with the help of these callers we were able to make a big impact.

Thank you to all those who completed the Customer First questionnaire. We are currently analysing your responses and will let you know how it went in the next issue of Gallions Grapevine.

New Reception

From October 2nd until the end of November, our reception service will be relocated to a temporary area while work is being done to the old reception. We wrote to you recently to tell you about this change, and we apologise for any inconvenience this may cause.

Our aim is to provide you with a new Customer Services Centre to make it easier for you to get your enquiries dealt with quickly and efficiently. The new reception will include four helpdesks, staffed by people able to deal with most eventualities.



ਜੇ ਅੰਗਰੇਜ਼ੀ ਤੁਹਾਡੀ ਪਹਿਲੀ ਭਾਸ਼ਾ ਨਹੀਂ, ਅਤੇ ਤੁਸੀਂ ਇਸ ਦਸਤਾਵੇਜ਼ ਦਾ ਤਰਜਮਾ ਚਾਹੁੰਦੇ ਹੋ, ਤਾਂ ਕਿਰਪਾ ਕਰਕੇ ਆਪਣੀ ਚੁਣੀ ਹੋਈ ਭਾਸ਼ਾ ਦੇ ਨਾਂ ਦੇ ਨੇੜੇ ਵਾਲੇ ਖ਼ਾਨੇ ਵਿਚ ਸਹੀ ਦਾ ਨਿਸ਼ਾਨ ਲਾ ਕੇ, ਅਤੇ ਦੱਸੀ ਹੋਈ ਥਾਂ 'ਤੇ ਆਪਣਾ ਨਾਂ ਅਤੇ ਪਤਾ ਲਿਖ ਕੇ ਇਹ ਫ਼ਾਰਮ ਕਿਸੇ ਲਿਫ਼ਾਫ਼ੇ ਵਿਚ ਪਾ ਕੇ ਹੇਠ ਲਿਖੇ ਪਤੇ 'ਤੇ ਭੇਜ ਦਿਓ।

如果英語不是您的母語，您希望將該文件翻譯出來的話，請在您選擇的語言旁邊打勾，請在所示之處填上您的姓名和地址，併用信封將本表格寄到下列地址。

Nếu Anh ngữ không phải là ngôn ngữ chính, Quý vị muốn dịch tài liệu này, xin vui lòng đánh dấu vào ô kế bên ngôn ngữ Quý vị chọn, ghi tên và địa chỉ vào nơi chỉ dẫn và gởi mẫu vào phòng bì theo địa chỉ đuổi dây.

PUNJABI ☐ **CHINESE** ☐ **VIETNAMESE** ☐ *(please tick one)*

Name: .....

Address: .....

.....

Return to: Caroline Wilson (Translation Requests), Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London SE2 9XH

Contacts

Gallions Housing Association
Harrow Manor Way
London SE2 9XH

Office opening hours:
Monday to Friday
between 9am and 5pm.

Main Switchboard
(for housing and other enquiries)
020 8310 1500

Repairs Freephone
0800 838481

Comfort 2000 Heating
020 8320 3422

Shield Security
020 8320 3439

Interserve
0800 389 0154